```
    "priority": 30,          <-- Matching template, but with a higher priority
    "template": { ... }
}
```

When multiple templates match the indexes being created, Elasticsearch applies all the settings from all matching templates, but the one with higher priority gets to the top. In the previous example, if `cars_template_mar21` has a codec that defines `best_compression`, it's overridden by a codec with a default value (defined in the `cars_template_feb21` template). That's because the latter template has a higher priority.

Now that we know more about index templates, let's look at reusable component templates.

6.6.2 Creating component templates

If you are from a DevOps background, at some point you've probably had a requirement to create indexes with a preset configuration for each environment. Rather than manually applying each configuration, you can create a component template for each environment.

A component template is nothing but a reusable block of configurations that we can use to make more index templates. However, component templates are of no value unless they are associated with index templates. They are exposed via a `_component_template` endpoint. Let's see how this fits together.

Let's say we need to create a template for a development environment that should have three primary shards with three replicas per shard. The first step is to declare and execute a component template with this configuration.

Listing 6.33 Developing a component template

```
POST _component_template/dev_settings_component_template
{
  "template":{
    "settings":{
      "number_of_shards":3,
      "number_of_replicas":3
    }
  }
}
```

In this listing, we use the `_component_template` endpoint to create a template. The body of the request holds the template information in a `template` object. Once executed, the `dev_settings_component_template` becomes available for use elsewhere in the index templates. Note that this template does not define an index pattern; it's simply a code block that configures some properties for us.

In the same way, let's create another template. This time, let's define a mapping schema.